

# Foundations

Operations Research - Mathematics

## 1. Purpose of the module

This week fixes the vocabulary the rest of the course depends on: the objects being studied, the operations defined on them, and the notation used throughout. Later material assumes these definitions without restating them.

## 2. Definitions and notation

Terms introduced here are used in their precise technical sense, which often differs from everyday usage. Where a symbol is introduced, its meaning holds for the remainder of the module unless explicitly redefined.

## 3. Prerequisites

The material assumes fluency with the preceding year of study. Where a prerequisite result is needed it is stated without proof and referenced, so gaps can be filled independently.